

MCQ - response to the bug report

Pages 12-18, plus a second testing pass. What changed, and why.

The short version

Most of the reports were not defects. They described situations the product had never taken a position on, so the honest fix was to take one rather than patch the example given.

The position taken, in one line:

A quiz's paper is fixed the moment the first student starts it. Its answer key is not.

That single rule answers five of the eight reports. The paper - the wording, the options, how many questions there are - is what students are compared on, so it must not move under them. The answer key is marking rather than assessment: correcting it changes nothing a student saw, and a wrong answer has to stay fixable.

This was not a new idea in the product. A quiz's settings - timing, passing score, retakes - have always locked as soon as a student starts. The question bank was simply never given the same rule. Applying it removes the whole class of "a teacher edited mid-attempt" problems at the source, instead of trying to reconcile two versions of a paper after the fact.

How each report was handled

DECISION

MCQ-BUG-011, 013, 015

A question added or removed while a student was part-way through never reached them, and a resumed attempt showed the old paper.

The paper is now fixed as soon as the first student starts it. Questions, options and how many there are cannot change after that.

This is the rule the quiz's settings have always followed, so the question bank was simply missing it. Students have to sit the same paper for their results to mean anything side by side - which is the harm the report describes. To change the questions after that, delete the assessment and publish a new one.

DECISION

MCQ-BUG-012, 016

An attempt was marked against the answer key that applied when the student started, so a correction never reached them.

The answer key is deliberately NOT part of the fixed paper. It stays correctable, and marking always uses the key as it stands when the paper is handed in.

A mis-keyed question is a mistake, not a change of assessment, and fixing it alters nothing the student sees. Freezing it would have made a wrong answer permanent. Results already recorded are brought up to date with Regrade submitted attempts.

FIXED

MCQ-BUG-014

The same quiz open in two tabs: the older tab could submit its stale answers over newer progress already saved.

Every save stamps the attempt with a version. A tab that has been overtaken says so and redraws itself from what is actually stored.

A real defect rather than a spec gap - last-write-wins with no way to detect it simply loses a student's work.

FIXED

MCQ-BUG-017

A quiz titled "Understanding <div> and <p> Tags" displayed as "Understanding and Tags".

Anything a person typed is escaped before it reaches the page.

The browser was reading the title as markup. The same hole would have run a script tag in a quiz title, so this was a security fix as much as a display one.

ALREADY FIXED

MCQ-BUG-018

Repeated assignment created duplicate quiz entries for teacher and student.

Already fixed before this pass: the duplicates came from a double-clicked Publish, which is now claimed once per draft. Assigning is idempotent too.

Six rapid clicks on Publish now produce exactly one quiz. Saving the same audience twice is a no-op rather than a delete-then-insert that could race.

Also found and fixed

A separate sweep over the parts of the app the report did not reach - two reviewers reading code, plus live testing with a teacher and a student signed in side by side. Twelve issues, each reproduced before it was touched and re-checked after.

Silent data loss

- Adding someone to a team and pressing Save members deleted them again, reporting "Team updated."
- An uploaded question bank could mark the wrong option correct, because the review table re-lettered options by position.
- Narrowing a quiz's audience hid results already recorded from every screen and export, while the dashboard kept counting them.
- A question written "1.What is 2+2?" was dropped from an upload with no skip note.

Security and access

- A removed administrator kept working in any open tab - including the form that let them add themselves back.
- The My teachers page could still be used to join and leave teachers after the account had been signed out elsewhere.

Correctness

- Two options that marking could not tell apart ("Paris" and "Paris.") passed validation, and which one counted depended on the shuffle.
- A question bank saved in Windows ANSI was read as unintelligible text, depending on whether the file's length was even.
- An email pasted with a trailing space created an account nobody could sign in to.

Clarity

- Deleting a quiz while a student was taking it removed their paper with no message, and the confirmation never said anyone was mid-attempt.
- Counts were not pluralised ("1 minutes", "1 members").

What this means for teachers

- Build and check the paper before you assign it. Student view lets you sit your own quiz and read it as a student does.
- Once the first student starts, the questions lock. The banner in Manage says so, and the upload option disappears.
- A wrong answer can still be corrected at any time. Save it, then use Regrade submitted attempts to apply it to results already in.
- Your own preview attempts never lock a quiz.
- If the paper itself is wrong after students have started, delete the assessment and publish a new one.

The in-app Guide and the teacher and student handouts have been updated to describe the rule, so the documentation and the app cannot disagree. Every fix is covered by a test that fails without it.